

Data gathering for requirements

- Interviews:
 - Props, e.g. sample scenarios of use, prototypes, can be used in interviews
 - Good for exploring issues
 - Development team members can connect with stakeholders
- Focus groups:
 - Group interviews
 - Good at gaining a consensus view and/or highlighting areas of conflict
 - But can be dominated by individuals

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- Questionnaires:
 - Often used in conjunction with other techniques
 - Can give quantitative or qualitative data
 - Good for answering specific questions from a large, dispersed group of people
- Researching similar products:
 - Good for prompting requirements

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- Direct observation:
 - Gain insights into stakeholders' tasks
 - Good for understanding the nature and context of the tasks
 - But, it requires time and commitment from a member of the design team, and it can result in a huge amount of data
- Indirect observation:
 - Not often used in requirements activity
 - Good for logging current tasks

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Studying documentation:

- Procedures and rules are often written down in manuals
- Good source of data about the steps involved in an activity, and any regulations governing a task
- Not to be used in isolation
- Good for understanding legislation, and getting background information
- No stakeholder time, which is a limiting factor on the other techniques

Contextual Inquiry

- An approach to ethnographic study where user is expert, designer is apprentice
- A form of interview, but
 - at users' workplace (workstation)
 - 2 to 3 hours long
- Four main principles:
 - Context: see workplace & what happens
 - Partnership: user and developer collaborate
 - Interpretation: observations interpreted by user and developer together
 - Focus: project focus to understand what to look for